

OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel: Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Workshops September 25th/26th November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

SEASON OF CREATION 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite:

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, details www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99

Sun 30th Aug

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MASSES

Saturday Vigil 6.00pm

Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm

Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS

Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm

Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm

Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS

Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES

Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE

71267070

1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ

Email: office@holyfamily-parish.com

Website: www.holyfamily-parish.com

Webcam: Click on website and follow the links

Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

DO WE DIRECT JESUS OR FOLLOW HIS DIRECTIONS?

Peter has just confessed that Jesus is the Christ, yet he cannot accept that the Messiah must suffer and die. He wants the glory of Christ without the Cross. Jesus tells him, "Get behind me," calling Peter back to his proper place: not directing Jesus, but following him. When Jesus asks us to deny ourselves, he is not asking us to hate ourselves or believe we are worthless. Rather, he asks us to surrender the false self that must always succeed, remain in control and avoid weakness. Taking up the cross means accepting the cost of loving faithfully, trusting that Christ walks before us. The Gospel contains a paradox: when we cling to life on our own terms, we lose it; when we entrust ourselves to Christ, we discover life. The question is not simply whether Jesus accompanies my plans, but whether I am willing to follow where he leads.

BAPTISMS Our Parish family welcomes: Fiadh Majella Millar Synge Court

EUCCHARISTIC MINISTERS FOR SEPTEMBER

Vigil Mass Paul Kite, Liam Whoriskey, Rose White

9:30am Brenda Brady, Andrea Devlin

11:00am Doreen Rice Wray, Margaret Hamilton, Eugene Mellon

12:30am Ann Gallagher, Margaret Harkin

READERS FOR September

Vigil Mass Sr. Ann **9.30am** Brenda Coyle

11am Jackie Conway **12.30pm** Patricia Murphy

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Dolores Tracey, Tony McGrellis, Brian Dillon, Frances Thompson, Bronco Bradley, Kathleen Toye, Eileen Hughes, Eugene McSherry Paul Coyle, John Dixon, Sarah Jane Campbell

SUNDAY COLLECTION 23rd August £2303.26 Standing Orders £400 and €154.29 Thank you for your generosity

MESSAGE FROM FR ANSELM MEO who was here a number of years ago. 'I am writing to you asking for your support for us. As you have known recently Flores island in Indonesia has been hit by earthquake in Saturday, August 15th, 2026. Up to now, the earthquake still going on and we live in tents due to the condition of the old parochial house. I now work in Datak Parish of Labuan Bajo Diocese. Some of the members of my family are in Mbay and they all in refugees without home. I, therefore on behalf of me and our parishioners and the people in Archdiocese of Ende, come to you Father and the parishioners of Holy Family, asking for support'. Envelopes are available at the back of the church for anyone who would like to contribute. You can return envelopes next weekend in the collection or drop them into the parish office.

CHILD SAFE GUARDING REFRESHER TRAINING

In 2023 all Parish Volunteers, Clergy and Employees received Child Safe guarding Training. It is necessary that this training is refreshed every three years. With this in mind all Parish Volunteers and Clergy and Employees are asked to attend refresher training in Holy Family Primary School on Thursday 10th September at 8.00pm. Please leave your name in the Parish Office to indicate your availability to attend.

HOLY FAMILY PADRE PIO GROUP Monthly devotions Tuesday 1st Sept. Rosary at 6:45pm and Mass at 7:15 Followed by Novena Prayers and Blessing with Relic of St Pio.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD."

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

ROSARY VIGIL FOR LIFE - outside Belfast City Hall on Sunday 30th August at 2.00pm. Join Precious Life in prayer pray that Belfast Council will reject plans to illuminate the City Hall in celebration of abortion. For more info Tel 028 9027 8484 /07592 280522b info@preciouslife.com

ANAM CARA Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings Tuesday 15 September at 7pm. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30pm. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca**. The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, celebrated by **Bishop Donal McKeown**, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information email info@catholicmothers.ie. All welcome